



Your best investment

Curiosity and life-long learning



Agenda

- Reading: Learning to learn
- Vocabulary: Ability and achievement
- Grammar: Multi-word verbs



Starting off

Look at the ways you could spend or invest your money. Which do you think would give you the greatest benefit over time?

- gym membership
- share in a new business
- membership in a networking organization
- job skills class
- savings account
- life or career coach



Vocabulary

Read the sentences. Match the word in bold in each sentence to its definition.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. Some people earn income additionally by investing money in other businesses. | a. a useful or valuable thing (n.) |
| 2. I don't have many assets , just a car and a nice bicycle. | b. as an extra factor or to introduce a new argument (adv.) |
| 3. Economists don't always agree on financial policies. | c. an expert in economics or the branch of knowledge concerned with wealth |
| 4. Entrepreneurs often work long hours as they try to get their businesses going. | d. able to develop or happen in the future |
| 5. New laws might potentially affect the prices of certain goods. | e. of great value (adj.) |
| 6. My time is very precious to me, so I don't like to waste it. | f. a conference or other meeting for discussion or training |
| 7. I don't invest in the stock market. I think it's too risky , so I choose safer options. | g. encourage development or increased activity in |
| 8. Do you want to attend this seminar on saving for retirement with me? | h. full of the possibility of danger, failure, or loss |
| 9. The government sometimes takes action that will stimulate the economy by creating new jobs. | i. cause to feel extreme fear |
| 10. The idea of failure terrifies me. I'm so afraid of not succeeding. | j. someone who sets up a business that might fail in the hope of earning a profit |



<https://wordwall.net/play/101103/340/445>

Lektor

Reading

Invest in Yourself

Billionaire investor Warren Buffett has often encouraged people to invest in themselves, saying it is their best investment. As a young man, he paid \$100 to take a course to help him with something that terrified him—public speaking. The class changed his life in more ways than one. In fact, in the middle of the course, he had gained so much confidence that he proposed to the woman who would become his wife. A small investment provided a big reward.

When we invest, we use our precious resources of time and/or money to improve our situation in life, usually to increase wealth. But experts, including many economists, suggest we should be investing more in ourselves. The rewards are potentially much greater (although they're not always financial), and it is much less risky than investing in some businesses.

So how can you invest in yourself? First, invest in your physical and mental health. A recent study showed that workers who participated in wellness programs increased their productivity as much as one extra workday per month. Getting more exercise, even standing, can help students study more and employees get more work done. Exercise not only improves your physical health, it also boosts your mental health. People who participate in activities like running are better at cognitive tasks, live longer, and are less likely to get dementia or other mental problems as they get older. Eating healthy food and getting more sleep are also important ways to improve

the quality of your life. If you want to protect your most important asset, you, then it's important to stay healthy.

Additionally, you can invest in yourself by learning and acquiring new skills. Free online classes and seminars are available on the Internet, or you can attend one at a local college or university. The time and money you spend will only make you more valuable in the job market. If you need to find a new position, you will have skills employers want. In the United States, workers will change jobs on average 12 times in their lifetimes (and four times before they are 32 years old). Taking a class or taking up a new hobby that is mentally stimulating can help you improve problem-solving skills.

Improving your health and increasing your skill set may be obvious ways to invest in yourself. However, many people don't consider giving themselves more free time as a way to increase their overall worth. A recent study showed that entrepreneurs generally work more than 50 hours a week. As a rule, they believe that working more will help their small businesses succeed. However, hiring more people can give a business owner more time. What should you do with more free time? Daydreaming can lead to greater creativity. More time for self-reflection can help you refocus on your goals. Taking the time to organize your life can let you produce more. Volunteering for good causes can make you more optimistic.

The bottom line? Investing in yourself is a wise way to spend your time and money.



Answer the questions about the article.

1. What did Warren Buffet spend \$100 on?
2. How does participating in wellness programs affect workers?
3. Why should people do sports like running?
4. How many times on average do U.S. workers change jobs over their lifetimes?
5. How many hours per week do entrepreneurs usually work?
6. What is a benefit of daydreaming?



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Recognizing and understanding generalizations

- A generalization is a broad statement used to describe what a group of people or things have in common. It uses information or observations to make a statement. Valid generalizations are based on factual information and logical thinking.
- To recognize valid generalizations, look for facts and specific words and phrases: *in general, generally, generally speaking, as a rule, the majority of, a small minority of, many, most.*
- *A recent study showed that entrepreneurs generally work more than 50 hours a week.*
- To recognize words and phrases that might signal faulty generalizations, look for *all, every, everyone, no one, always, and never.*



Practice

1. But experts, including many economists, ...
 2. A recent study showed that workers who participated in wellness programs ...
 3. Getting more exercise, even standing, can help students study more and employees ...
 4. In the United States, workers will change jobs ...
 5. However, many people don't consider giving themselves ...
 6. A recent study showed that entrepreneurs ...
 7. As a rule, they believe that ...
- a) generally work more than 50 hours a week.
 - b) get as much as 25 percent more work done according to a university study.
 - c) on average 12 times in their lifetimes and four times before they are 32 years old.
 - d) suggest we should be investing more in ourselves.
 - e) working more will help their small businesses succeed.
 - f) increased their productivity as much as one extra workday per month.
 - g) more free time as a way to increase value.



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Grammar: Structures with infinitive

- *Want* and *allow* are followed by object + to infinitive.
 - *Billionaire investor Warren Buffett wants people to invest in themselves.*
 - *It allows them to develop better skills.*
- ***Want* can also be followed by the infinitive with *to*.**
 - *If you want to protect your most important asset, then it's important to stay healthy.*
- *Make* and *let* are followed by object + infinitive without *to*.
 - *My desire to improve my life makes me invest time and resources in myself.*
 - *Taking the time to organize your life can let you produce more.*



Grammar: Infinitive constructions

We use the *to* infinitive:

- after certain adjectives or nouns (e.g., *easy, difficult*), *too* + adjective, *something/nothing/anything/anywhere/nowhere, time*.
 - *I always find it difficult to speak to strangers.*
 - *I'm finding it too cold to work in here.*
 - *Come on, it's time to go.*
 - *Do you have anything to eat?*
- after some nouns + *be*.
 - *My suggestion would be to paint it all blue.*
 - *The plan is to get going tomorrow.*



Grammar: purpose clauses

- We use purpose clauses to talk about the reasons why someone does something. Purpose clauses answer a “why” question. We use phrases such as *in order to* or *so as to* + infinitive to give the reason for doing something. *In order to* is generally considered more formal.
 - *They went to the drugstore to buy some more painkillers but it was closed.*
 - *We went to Paris so as to learn French, but spent most of the time speaking English!*
 - *In order to* obtain your driver’s licence, you have to pass a theory and practical test.
- We use *so as not to* and *in order not to* to make the negative form.
 - *So as not to hear them*, she turned the music up!
(NOT *So as to not hear them!*)
 - *In order not to miss her appointment*, she used four alarm clocks.
(NOT *in order to not miss ...*)
- But we can’t use *not to* on its own.
She turned up the music so as not to hear them.
(NOT *She turned up the music not to hear them.*)
- We can also use *so (that)* + clause to talk about the reasons for doing something.
 - *She stood up so (that) she could see better.*
 - *Why don’t you call them so (that) they know you’re interested in the project?*
- If we put the purpose clause first, it sounds more formal.
 - *So (that) I could hear him better, I asked him to sit closer.* (More formal)
 - *I asked him to sit closer so (that) I could hear him better.*



That's all, folks!

